The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Department of Information Technology



Proposal

for

Travel and Blogging Platform

Version 1.0

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1. Introduction

This proposal presents the Travel and Blogging Platform, a web application where travelers can discover destinations, read travel blogs, and publish their own experiences in one place.

Travel information today is spread across social media posts, personal blogs, and booking sites. A traveler who wants tips, itineraries, and honest reviews for one destination has to search several sources and cannot easily tell which are reliable. At the same time, people who enjoy writing about their trips often have no simple, dedicated space to reach an audience.

The proposed platform brings both groups together. Visitors can browse and search content freely, registered bloggers can write and manage posts, and an administrator moderates the site so that quality stays high. The system will be built with PHP, MySQL (via XAMPP), HTML, CSS and Bootstrap, and will work on both desktop and mobile browsers.

2. Problem Statement

Travelers lack a single, organized place to find destination guides and real experiences from other travelers, and writers lack a simple platform to publish and manage that content.

The main problems with the current situation are:

- Travel content is scattered across many websites and social media pages, so searching takes time.
- Posts on open social platforms are rarely moderated, which makes quality and accuracy uncertain.
- Many large travel sites focus on bookings, not on personal stories, tips, and itineraries.
- Independent bloggers have to set up and maintain their own websites to reach readers.
- Readers have limited ways to discuss a post, ask questions, or share it with others.

This project addresses these problems with a moderated, searchable, community-driven platform dedicated to travel blogging.

3. Objectives

The project aims to deliver a working, secure and easy-to-use travel blogging website. Its specific objectives are:

1. Build a web platform where visitors can browse travel destinations and read blogs without logging in.
2. Provide secure registration and login so that users can manage their own profiles.
3. Let registered bloggers create, edit, publish and delete their travel blogs.
4. Add an admin approval step so that a blog becomes public only after review.
5. Allow readers to comment on blogs and share them on social media.
6. Provide search for travel tips, itineraries and personal experiences.
7. Give the administrator tools to manage users, blogs and comments.
8. Deliver a responsive design that works on phones, tablets and desktops.
9. Protect user data by hashing passwords and using encrypted connections.

4. Scope

The first version covers the core blogging and browsing features of a web-based travel platform, with English as the main language.

In scope	Out of scope (possible future work)
Browsing travel destinations	Online booking of hotels, flights or tours
Reading, writing, editing and deleting travel blogs	Native Android and iOS apps
Registration, login and user profile management	Payment processing
Commenting on blogs and sharing on social media	Multi-language support (localization)
Search for tips, itineraries and experiences	Real-time chat between users
Admin approval of blogs and management of users and comments	Recommendation engine based on user behavior
Responsive layout for modern browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge)	

5. Proposed System

The system serves three types of users, and each one gets a different set of features.

Actor	What they can do
Visitor	View blogs and destinations, search content, comment on blogs, register an account
Travel Blogger (registered user)	Log in, manage a profile, write, edit and delete blogs, share blogs on social media
Admin	Approve or reject blogs, manage user accounts, moderate comments, oversee the website

The typical flow is as follows. A user registers and verifies their email, then logs in and writes a blog. The blog is sent to the admin for review. After approval it becomes publicly visible, where visitors can read, search, comment on and share it.

Key business rules

- A password must be at least 8 characters long.
- A blog is publicly visible only after admin approval.
- Only registered users can create, edit and publish blogs.

6. Technology Stack and Methodology

The platform uses common, well-documented open-source tools that run on a student machine.

Layer	Technology
Frontend	HTML, CSS, Bootstrap
Backend	PHP
Database	MySQL
Local server	XAMPP (Apache + MySQL)
Browsers	Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Safari, Microsoft Edge
Modeling	UML use case diagrams

Requirement identification. Requirements are gathered with use case diagrams for the Visitor, Blogger and Admin, and each use case is described with a standard template (trigger, preconditions, normal flow, alternative flows, exceptions, business rules).

Development approach. The project follows an incremental model: requirements, design, implementation, testing, then deployment. Each module (users, blogs, comments, admin) is built and tested before the next one starts.

7. Requirements Summary

The full details are in the Software Requirements Specification (SRS, Version 1.0). The main requirements are summarized below.

Functional requirements

ID	Title	Summary	Priority
FR-1	User Registration	A user creates an account with username, email and password; the system checks the email format and password length.	High
FR-2	Blog Post Creation	A registered user creates, edits and publishes blogs; an admin must approve a blog before it is public. Depends on FR-1.	High

Non-functional requirements

ID	Category	Requirement
USE-1	Usability	Easy navigation for blog posts and destination exploration.
USE-2	Usability	Simple registration and login with clear error messages.
PER-1	Performance	95% of pages load in under 3 seconds on standard broadband.
SEC-1	Security	All passwords are hashed before storage.
SEC-2	Security	SSL/TLS encryption protects data in transit.

Constraints. The backend must use PHP with XAMPP (CO-1), and the site must be optimized for both mobile and desktop browsers (CO-2).

8. Project Timeline

The work is planned as six sequential phases over 16 weeks. This is a proposed schedule and can be adjusted to the semester calendar.

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Each phase ends with a short review with the supervisor before the next phase begins.

9. Expected Outcomes

At the end of the project the following will be delivered:

- A working Travel and Blogging Platform with visitor, blogger and admin features.
- A MySQL database for users, blogs, destinations and comments.
- The SRS document, use case diagrams, and a final project report.
- Test results showing that the main features work on desktop and mobile browsers.
- A user manual and a project demonstration.

10. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Delay in development	Build module by module and review progress with the supervisor each phase.
Spam or inappropriate blogs and comments	Admin approval of blogs and comment moderation tools.
Security attacks such as SQL injection	Validate all input, use prepared statements, hash passwords, and use SSL/TLS.
Slow pages as content grows	Optimize database queries and images; target 95% of pages under 3 seconds.
Layout problems on different devices	Use Bootstrap and test on several browsers and screen sizes.

11. Conclusion

The Travel and Blogging Platform gives travelers one place to find trustworthy destination information and gives bloggers a simple way to share their stories. It uses familiar, low-cost tools (PHP, MySQL, XAMPP, Bootstrap), has clear requirements in the SRS, and can be completed within one project cycle. The design also leaves room for later additions such as multiple languages, booking links, and a mobile app. We request approval to proceed with this project.

References

- PHP official website
- W3Schools PHP tutorial
- Apache Friends (XAMPP)